

Laura García Montoya

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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor, University of Toronto
The Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy

July 2022 -
Present

Assistant Professor, Universidad del Rosario
Facultad de Estudios Políticos, Internacionales y Urbanos

January 2022 -
July 2022

Visiting Fellow, University of Notre Dame
Kellogg Institute for International Studies

August 2021 -
December 2021

Postdoctoral Researcher, Princeton University
Department of Politics, Bobst Center for Peace and Justice

September 2020 -
August 2021

EDUCATION

Northwestern University, USA

PhD, Political Science

September 2020

Fields: Comparative Politics, Methodology

Dissertation: *Trapped by Inequality: The Politics of Redistribution in Latin America*

M.S in Statistics

September 2020

Thesis: *Measuring Essentially Contested Concepts*

M.A in Political Science

December 2018

Universidad de los Andes, Colombia

M.A in Economics

March 2013

Thesis: *Evaluating the Symptoms of Rent-seeking in Colombian Municipalities.*

B.A in Economics

March 2012

RESEARCH

Book Project

Contested Development: Land Reform Sequences and the Remaking of Inequality in Latin America

Working Papers

- . **García-Montoya, Laura** and Pilar Manzi. ‘The Politics of Offshore Exit: Redistributive Threats and Elite Wealth Defense.’
- . Güiza-Gómez, Diana Isabel and **García-Montoya, Laura**. ‘Land Dispossession on Trial: Socially Embedded Claims and Judicial Behavior in the Colombian Land Restitution Program.’ [*Under Review*]
 – Winner of the REPAL Best Paper Award (2025).

Selected Work in Progress

- . The Pacifying Role of Education: The Case of Radio Sutatenza in Colombia (with Leopoldo Fergusson, María Medellín, and Bruno Cardinale)
- . Long-Term and Dynamic Consequences of Land Reform in Perú (with Ethan Kaplan and Mateo Uribe)
- . Emergence and Dynamics of the “Environmental State” in Colombia (Book Chapter, Under Review)
- . Inequality and Poverty in Colombia (Chapter in preparation for *De Gruyter Handbook on Latin American Politics*)

Book Chapters

Mahoney, James & **García-Montoya, Laura** (2021). “Critical Event Analysis” in J. Mahoney. *The Logic of Social Science*. Princeton University Press. P 269-294

Other Publications

2. **García-Montoya, Laura** (2024). An Integrative Framework to Assess Trade-Offs and Implications of Choosing Measurements. *Kellogg Working Paper Series, University of Notre Dame*. <https://doi.org/10.7274/27156087.v1>
1. Otero-Bahamón, Silvia, **García-Montoya, Laura** & Juan José Fernández-Dusso. (2022). “Nuevas Perspectivas Sobre Desigualdad y Política Social En América Latina”. *Revista CS*, Special Issue. July. Pages 11 - 18. <https://doi.org/10.18046/recs.iEspecial.5644>

Working papers

- . Güiza-Gómez and **García-Montoya, Laura**. “Land Dispossession on Trial: Claim-Making and Judicial Behavior in the Colombian Land Restitution Program”. [*Under Review*]
 – Winner of Repal Best-paper prize (2024).

Selected Work in Progress

- . Wealth Defense and Taxation: Exploring the Effects of Off-Shore Accounts Usage on Inequality (with Pilar Manzi)

- . The Pacifying Role of Education: the case of Radio Sutatenza in Colombia (with Leopoldo Fergusson, María Medellín, and Bruno Cardinale)
- . Long-Term and Dynamic Consequences of Land Reform in Perú (with Ethan Kaplan and Mateo Uribe)
- . Emergence and Dynamics of the “Environmental State” in Colombia (Book Chapter, Under Review)
- . Inequality and Poverty in Colombia (Chapter in preparation for De Gruyter Handbook on Latin American Politics)

Public Writing

- . **García-Montoya, Laura** & Isabel Güiza-Gómez. “Colombians are occupying land to protest inequality. Here’s the history.” *The Monkey Cage*, *Washington Post*, October 2022. [Link to Column](#)
- . **García-Montoya, Laura** & Isabel Güiza-Gómez. “Reformismo agrario, paz y democracia en Colombia” *Periodico Universidad Nacional*, October 2022. [Link to Column](#)
- . **García-Montoya, Laura** & Isabel Güiza-Gómez. “El fantasma de las invasiones de tierras: implicaciones para la Reforma Agraria” *La Silla Vacía*, October 2022. [Link to Column](#)
- . **García-Montoya, Laura** “Techos rotos de la segunda vuelta” *Razón Pública*, June 2022. [Link to Column](#)
- . **García-Montoya, Laura** & Arturo Chang. “La historia del “progreso” que deja atrás a millones en Colombia: Algunas lecciones de la movilización nacional”. *La Silla Llena*, July 2021. [Link to Column](#)
- . Chang, Arturo & **Laura García-Montoya**. “Colombia’s “Progress” Leaves Millions Behind”. *Foreign Policy*, June 2021. [Link to Column](#)
- . **García-Montoya, Laura** and James Mahoney “The Logic of Critical Event Analysis”. *Trajectories*, *Newsletter of the ASA Comparative and Historical Sociology Section*, Vol 30 No 2-3. Winter/Spring 2019. [Link to Essay](#)
- . Castillo, Isabel and **Laura García-Montoya** “Orden y Progreso: Historia de las profundas desigualdades en Chile”. *Foco Económico. Un Blog Latinoamericano de Economía y Política*. November, 2019. [Link to Column](#)

GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

- 2026 SSHRC Connection Grant 23100 CAD
- munk ad hoc funds
- 2025 SIG . CAD 6000
- munk ad hoc funds
- 2024 Munk School Seed Grant Program. CAD 2000
- 2024 APSA Summer Centennial Center Research Grant. USD 10,000
- Scholarship as an invited guest researcher of the project “Extractivism in Latin America and the Maghreb”, University of Kassel
- 2023 SSHRC Insight Development Grant 2023-2025, “The Long-Term Economic and Political Consequences of Land Reform: Evidence from Perú”. CAD 74,000
- Munk School Seed Grant Program. CAD 5000
- 2021 Kellogg Institute for International Studies, Visiting Fellow, University of Notre Dame
- 2020 Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice, Postdoctoral Fellow, Princeton University
- Latin American and Caribbean Studies, Research Grant, Northwestern University
- Political Science Department Nominee for Weinberg College Outstanding Graduate Student Teacher Award, Northwestern University (Award postponed due to Covid)
- 2019 Dispute Resolution Research Center, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University
- Latin American and Caribbean Studies, Dissertation Summer Research Grant, Northwestern University
- Presidential Fellowship Nominee, Northwestern University
- Travel Conference Award, Political Science Department, Northwestern University

- 2018 Dissertation Research Travel Award, Buffett Institute, Northwestern University
- Travel Conference Award, Political Science Department, Northwestern University
- CHSS Global Partnership grant to attend Conference in Florence
- Travel Conference Award, The Graduate School, Northwestern University
- Travel Conference Award, Buffet Institute, Northwestern University
- 2017 Travel Conference Award, The Graduate School, Northwestern University
- Political Science Department Grant to attend IQMR, Northwestern University
- Comparative Historical Social Sciences Workshop Travel Research Grant, Northwestern University
- 2016 Dissertation Research Travel Award, Buffett Institute, Northwestern University

INVITED TALKS

- 2025 “Del caos a la resiliencia: cómo se reinventan las democracias en tiempos de crisis.” Invited to speak at a panel on Democratic Resilience led by Asuntos del Sur. Universidad de los Andes, November 24.
- “Entrando en la arena política en contextos excluyentes: el giro a la izquierda desde las bases en Colombia”. Seminario Internacional de Investigación, Facultad de Gobierno de la Universidad de Chile. May 27, 2025.
- 2024 “Policy Conflict and the Political Economy of Land Restitution in Colombia”. Extractivism Annual Conference. Kassel University, July 2nd.
- “How Political Assassinations Impact Participation: Evidence from Colombia”. Microeconomics Seminar, Department of Economics at York University, March 21st.
- “Policy Conflict and the Political Economy of Land Restitution in Colombia”. Comparative Politics Workshop, Northwestern University, March 1st.
- 2023 “Trapped by Inequality: Narratives of Progress and The Politics of Redistribution in Latin America”. LCR Economics Seminar Series: Origins of Inequality in Latin America. World Bank. April 20th
- 2022 “Trapped by Inequality: Politics of Redistribution and Development Paradigms in Latin America”. Universidad Católica de Uruguay, July 13th.
- “Entering the Political Arena: Institutional Claim-making for Redistribution and the Left Turn in Post-Accord Colombia”. Universidad del Rosario, Departamento de Economía. Political Economy Workshop. June 13
- “What is happening in Colombia? A conversation with experts”. Center for Latin American Studies at the University of Utah. May 24. [Link to Video](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 APSA
 LASA

2024 REPAL
 “Land Dispossession on Trial: Claim-Making and Judicial Behavior in the Colombian Land Restitution Program”, LASA, June 12th-June 15th.

 “Emergence and Dynamics of the “Environmental State” in Colombia”, LASA, June 12th-June 15th.

 “Policy Conflict and the Political Economy of Land Restitution in Colombia”.PCJ Conference, University of Toronto, January 26th.

2023 “How Political Assassinations Impact Participation: Evidence from Colombia”. International Economics Association, December 14th.

 Workshop: “El Estado del ‘Estado Verde’ en los países andinos: Estructuras, actores y desafíos”, trAndes and PUCP, Lima, Nov 7 - 8.

 “Policy Conflict: Ethnic Land Restitution and Natural Resource Extraction in Colombia”. APSA. September 2

- 2023 “Redistributive Politics: Wealth Defense and Taxation”’. MPSA. April 14th cont.
- “Entering the Political Arena: Institutional Claim-making for Redistribution and the Left Turn in Post-Accord Colombia”. Munk Research Seminar. April 12th
- “Entering the Political Arena: Institutional Claim-making for Redistribution and the Left Turn in Post-Accord Colombia”. GTAL. February 24
- 2022 “Entering the Political Arena: Institutional Claim-making for Redistribution and the Left Turn in Post-Accord Colombia”. SWMMR. University of Notre Dame. October 27 - 28.
- “Entering the Political Arena: Institutional Claim-making for Redistribution and the Left Turn in Post-Accord Colombia”. Repal, Universidad Torcuato Di Tella. June 30 – July 1
- “Land Restitution and Racial Inequality in Colombia’s Post-conflict Transition: Examining Tensions Between Collective Land Titles and ”Development” Latin American Studies Association. San Francisco. May 5–8, 2022
- Colombian Studies Initiative Faculty Working Group NYU and Universidad del Rosario. April 28.
- 2021 “Land Restitution and Racial Inequality in Colombia’s Post-conflict Transition”. Kroc-Kellogg peace, conflict, crime and violence workshop. University of Notre Dame. December 2
- ““Which Oppression?” Narratives of National Progress and Popular Organizing in 1970s Colombia”. South West Mixed Methods. Evanston. Nov 4 - 5
- “The Politics of Redistribution in Latin America: Tax legislation in Colombia and Perú in comparative perspective”. Repal, Cornell University Einaudi Center’s Latin American Studies Program, July 15- 17th
- 2020 “The pacifying role of education: The case of Radio Sutatenza.” American Political Science Association. Annual meeting, San Francisco. September 10 - 13
- “The Politics of Redistribution in Latin America: Tax legislation in Colombia and Perú in comparative perspective”. Repal, Universidad di Tella, Buenos Aires. June 15-16.
- “The Politics of Redistribution in Latin America: Tax Reforms in Colombia and Perú in the 1930s”. LACS Graduate Workshop. Northwestern University. January 30.

- 2019 “The pacifying role of education: the case of Radio Sutatenza”. Annual Southwest Workshop on Mixed Methods Research, ITAM, Mexico City. October 24-25
- “Measuring Essentially Contested Concepts”. Comparative Historical Social Sciences Workshop - Northwestern University. Fall
- “The pacifying role of education: the case of Radio Sutatenza”. Latin American Studies Association. Annual Meeting, Boston. May 24-27
- “Paths of Economic Inequality in Latin America: The State and The Politics of Distribution” V Seminario Desigualdad y Movilidad Social en América Latina. Annual meeting, Santiago de Chile. May 6-8
- “The Impact of Selective Violence during War on the Quality of Local Government.” Midwest Political Science Association. Annual Meeting, Chicago. April 4-7
- 2018 “Relative Power of the State: A Theory of Economic Inequality”, Presented at the EDGS series at Buffet Institute. Fall.
- “The Logic of Critical Event Analysis.” American Political Science Association. Annual meeting, Boston. August 30 - Sep 2
- “The Logic of Critical Event Analysis.” American Sociological Association. Annual meeting, Philadelphia. August 11-14
- “Paths of Economic Inequality: The Relative Power of the State” Summer Conference on Economy and Society. Annual meeting, European University Institute, Florence, Italy. July 1 - 4.
- “Paths of Economic Inequality: The Relative Power of the State”. Comparative Politics Workshop, Political Science Department, Northwestern University
- “Paths of Economic Inequality: Parasitism in Colombia.” Chicago area Comparative Historical Social Sciences Conference. Chicago. May 10 - 11.
- “Paths of Economic Inequality: Parasitism in Colombia.” Midwest Political Science Association. Annual Meeting, Chicago. April 5 - 8
- 2017 “State Formation and Power: Production and Reproduction of Inequality in Latin America”. Latin American Studies Association, Annual Meeting, Lima. April 29 - May 1.
- “State Building and Inequality in Latin America: A Critical Juncture Approach”. Comparative Historical Social Sciences Workshop - Northwestern University. Spring
- “State Building and Inequality in Latin America: A Critical Juncture Approach” Midwest Political Science Association. Annual Meeting, Chicago. April 6 - 9.
- “A Dynamic Approach to the Relationship between Inequality and Civil War” Midwest Political Science Association. Annual Meeting, Chicago. April 6 - 9.
- 2013 “Evaluating the symptoms of rent-seeking in Colombian municipalities.” Latin American Association of Political Science. Annual meeting, Bogota. September 26-28.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Toronto, Munk School of Global Affairs and Public Policy

- Quantitative Methods for Policy Analysis (MPP) (Fall 2022, Fall 2024)
- Research Methods in Peace, Conflict, and Justice (PCJ) (Fall 2024)
- Introduction to Peace, Conflict and Justice II: Exploring Violent Conflicts through the Lenses of Inequality (PCJ) (Spring 2023, 2024)
- Topics in Development II: Conflict and Post-Conflict Transitions (MGA) (Winter 2024)

Invited Lectures / Courses

- Munk PPG Contentious Politics Course (Winter 2024)
- Munk 200 - Post-conflict Transitions and Inequality (Winter 2023, Winter 2024)

The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), University of Syracuse

- Module on Qualitative Methods (Summer 2024) (with James Mahoney and Gary Goertz)

Universidad del Rosario, Facultad de Estudios Políticos, Internacionales y Urbanos

- Política Económica Colombiana (Spring 2022)
- Métodos de Análisis Cuantitativo para Ciencias Sociales (Spring 2022)

Northwestern University, Department of Political Science

- Lecturer of Politics of Latin America (Spring 2020)

Teaching Assistant to Graduate level courses:

- Introduction to Probability and Statistics (Fall 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018)
- Linear Models (Winter 2016)
- Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference (Spring 2016, Spring 2018)

Teaching Assistant to Undergraduate level courses:

- Honors Thesis (Fall 2019, Winter 2020)
- Topics in Managerial Analytics: Analytics for Strategy (Applied econometrics for Kellogg Certificate) (Winter 2019)
- Drugs and Politics (Spring 2017)
- Global Development (Winter 2017)

Invited Lectures/Workshops

- Introduction to R for Stata Users (Summer 2019)
- Lecture on Data Visualization, Linear Models (Winter 2019)
- Data Science Research Consultant, Research Computing Services Team (2019)

- R Workshop: Selected among graduate students to develop and teach a series of 10 R workshops (Summer, Fall 2018)
- Math Camp - R instructor (September 2017, 2018)

Universidad de Los Andes**Teaching Assistant in the Department of Economics**

- Competition and Regulation (Master's course)
- Introduction to the Colombian Economy
- Introduction to Microeconomics

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Reviewer: *American Political Science Review*, *Perspectives on Politics*, *American Sociological Review*, *Journal of Politics*, *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*, *Canadian Journal of Latin American and Caribbean Studies*, *Latin American Research Review*, *Revista Cuadernos de Economía*, *Universidad Nacional de Colombia*, *Revista de Ciencia Política*, *Sociological Methods and Research*, *Journal of Latin American Studies*, *Political Studies*, *Studies in Comparative International Development*

Organization Committee of Southwest Workshop on Mixed Methods Research: 2022-present

Professional Associations: *American Political Science Association*, *Latin American Studies Association*, *Midwest Political Science Association*, *REPAL*

SERVICE TO UNIVERSITY**University of Toronto**

Anti-racism Action Table (Fall 2022 to present)

Social Movements Workshop co-organizer (Fall 2023-present)

Dissertation Committee Member Maria Francisca Granda

Universidad del Rosario

Comité de Investigación FEIPU

Jurado Tesis Catalina Chacón

Northwestern University

Graduate Student Coordinator, Comparative Historical Social Science Workshop (2016-2017)

Graduate Students Association (Commune) Co-Chair, Department of Political Science (2017-2018)

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- European Consortium for Political Research, Summer School in Methods and Techniques - Central European University, July 2017
 - Process Tracing Methodology: Foundations and Guidelines
 - Introduction to Machine Learning
- The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research - Syracuse University, June 2017
 - Qualitative Methods for Causal Analysis
 - Designing and Conducting Field Research
 - Within-Case and Small-N Analysis
 - Introduction to Interpretative/Ethnographic Methods
- Teaching Certificate Program, Political Science Department, Northwestern University. Academic year 2016-2017.

SKILLS

Languages: Native Spanish, Fluent English

Software: R (advanced), Stata (advanced), Python (Beginner)